

Impact Projection

Project: Sahayak - Welfare Scheme Discovery Assistant

Objective

This document estimates the potential social impact of Sahayak if used by NSS volunteers, NGOs, or local field workers during welfare awareness drives. The projection is conservative and intended to show the order of magnitude of possible benefit, not claim measured deployment impact.

Impact Logic

Sahayak improves outcomes by reducing friction in four steps:

1. Awareness: user discovers relevant schemes.
2. Comprehension: user understands why the scheme may apply.
3. Preparation: user receives a document checklist.
4. Action: user is more likely to apply through official channels.

Diagram: Rendered in the Visual Diagrams Appendix PDF.

Base Assumptions

Variable	Conservative assumption
Outreach population in pilot district/NGO program	10,000 people
Share likely eligible for at least one listed scheme	40%
Eligible people in target population	4,000
Current awareness/completion gap	Significant, based on official challenge framing
Additional users who attempt application due to Sahayak	10-20% of eligible users
Successful completion among additional attempts	40-60%

Scenario Model

Conservative Scenario

- Eligible users: 4,000.
- Additional application attempts due to Sahayak: 10% = 400.
- Successful completion rate among additional attempts: 40%.
- Additional successful enrollments/applications: 160.

Moderate Scenario

- Eligible users: 4,000.
- Additional application attempts due to Sahayak: 15% = 600.
- Successful completion rate among additional attempts: 50%.
- Additional successful enrollments/applications: 300.

High Scenario

- Eligible users: 4,000.
- Additional application attempts due to Sahayak: 20% = 800.
- Successful completion rate among additional attempts: 60%.
- Additional successful enrollments/applications: 480.

Entitlement Value Illustration

The value differs by scheme. The table below uses illustrative benefits from the current catalogue and should be verified scheme-by-scheme before field reporting.

Scheme	Benefit type	Example value mechanism
PM-KISAN	Direct income support	Rs. 6,000 per year for eligible farmer families
PM-JAY	Health protection	Up to Rs. 5 lakh annual family health cover
Ujjwala	Clean cooking fuel support	Deposit-free LPG connection and related support
PMAY-U	Housing support	Housing construction/purchase/rental assistance
NSAP	Social assistance	Pension or family benefit support
PM SVANidhi	Livelihood credit	Working capital loan and incentives
APY	Pension	Guaranteed pension after age 60 based on contributions
Sukanya	Savings	Government-backed girl-child savings account

PM-KISAN Example Calculation

If only 50 of the additional successful applications are PM-KISAN enrollments:

50 households x Rs. 6,000 per year = Rs. 3,00,000 per year

If 200 households are helped over a larger outreach cycle:

200 households x Rs. 6,000 per year = Rs. 12,00,000 per year

This calculation covers only one scheme. Health coverage, housing support, pension support, and livelihood credit can create additional financial protection beyond direct cash transfer.

Time and Process Savings

Sahayak can also reduce non-cash friction:

Friction point	Expected improvement
Finding relevant schemes	One guided profile instead of manual searching
Understanding eligibility	Short reason bullets per recommendation
Preparing documents	Copyable/downloadable checklist
Avoiding wrong applications	Better profile-to-scheme matching
Field-worker triage	Faster beneficiary screening during camps

If a field worker saves even 10 minutes per beneficiary screened, then:

1,000 screened users x 10 minutes = 10,000 minutes saved

10,000 minutes = 166.7 hours saved

Cost Projection

MVP Cost

Cost head	Estimate
Hosting	Free on GitHub Pages
Frontend framework	None
Data storage	Static files
Maintenance	Volunteer/developer time
Field usage	Any phone/browser

Future WhatsApp/SMS Cost

Costs would depend on message volume and provider pricing. The current architecture keeps the core logic text-based, so the same recommendation and retrieval engine can later be exposed through a WhatsApp/SMS backend.

Sustainability Pathway

1. NSS volunteers use the tool during awareness camps.
2. Local NGOs validate scheme coverage and language clarity.
3. Additional schemes/languages are added based on local need.
4. District-level or NGO-level deployment integrates WhatsApp/SMS.
5. Field feedback updates scheme data and document requirements.

Impact Metrics to Track in Pilot

Metric	Why it matters
Flow completion rate	Measures usability
Comprehension score	Measures whether users understood scheme summaries
Checklist usefulness rating	Measures actionability
Application intent	Measures likely next step
Actual application attempt	Measures conversion
Successful enrollment	Measures final welfare uptake

Conclusion

Sahayak's impact comes from increasing successful navigation of existing welfare schemes. Even modest improvements in awareness and document readiness can translate into meaningful entitlement access, especially when the tool is used by NSS volunteers or NGOs across repeated community outreach sessions.